

School of Education/English Department ENGL251/Communication Skills	Midterm Exam Version A Fall 2023-24	Time: 75 min Instructor: Campus:
Student's Name: ID:	Section:	Grade/100:

Part One: Objective Component (20 points)

1. Choose the correct answer. (10 points)

1. What should you eliminate in your writing to make it more concise? A. Relevant details B. Flabby expressions C. Main ideas D. Proper punctuation	4. What is the first phase of the 3-X-3 writing process? A. Drafting B. Revising C. Prewriting D. Editing
2. What are key technological trends in Business Communication? A. Fax and landlines B. Mobile and cloud computing C. Postal mail D. Bulletin boards	5. Which aspect of communication involves understanding messages without words? A. Verbal B. Nonverbal C. Symbols D. Short messages
3. What should you use for presenting information in the body of your email? A. Long paragraphs B. Extremely short sentences C. Bulleted or numbered lists D. Only images	

2. Answer by True or False. Correct the False statements. (10 points)

Statement	True or False	Correct false statement here
1. Time orientation is a universal concept, unaffected by culture.		
2. Companies should only focus on traditional direct mail and ignore social/digital marketing.		
3. Sales letters are a part of a package with various persuasive elements.		
4. A buffer in an indirect negative message should include false impressions to make the news seem less bad.		
5. A compound sentence contains two complete but related thoughts.		

Part Two: Reading a Business Message Critically (20 points)

Read the following persuasive email and analyze its effectiveness by answering the questions listed after the email. Answer in 2-3 sentences.

Dear Ms. Ramirez,

I hope this email finds you well. I am reaching out to present an exciting opportunity for your esteemed company, Global Dynamics, to partner with Innovative Solutions Ltd. We believe that our state-of-the-art software solutions perfectly complement the services your company offers.

Given the rapid technological changes in our industry, it's more crucial than ever to stay ahead of the curve. By integrating our advanced software into your existing system, Global Dynamics can enhance efficiency, reduce operational costs, and gain a competitive edge in the market.

I would be honored to schedule a virtual meeting next week to delve deeper into this potential collaboration. Please let me know a time that works best for you, and we can take this forward.

Looking forward to the possibility of a mutually beneficial partnership.

Warm regards,

David Mitchell - Business Development Manager- Innovative Solutions Ltd

1. How does the email capture the reader's attention in the opening? Is it effective? (5 points)

2. What is the main message of the email? (5 points)

3. Does the email use direct or indirect approach? Explain. (5 points)

4. How effective is the email's call to action? Does it provide a clear next step for the recipient? (5 points)

Read the following poorly written email carefully. Notice the language errors, inappropriate casual tone, and the lack of persuasive elements in the email. Rewrite the email in a more professional and persuasive manner. Make sure to correct the language errors, adjust the tone to be more appropriate for a workplace setting, and include persuasive elements to convince the recipient of the need and benefit of your vacation time.

Subject:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue or grey ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Part Four: Writing a Business Message (50 points)

Choose **ONE** of the following prompts:

1. Prompt 1:

Direct Approach: Delay in Product Delivery

Context: You are the supply chain manager of a manufacturing company. Due to unforeseen circumstances, there will be a significant delay in the delivery of one of the key products. You need to notify your major distributors about this setback.

Prompt: Write an email to your distributors, directly informing them of the delay. Highlight the reasons causing the delay, the expected duration of the setback, and the steps you're taking to resolve the issue. Assure them that measures are being put in place to avoid such hiccups in the future and express gratitude for their patience and understanding.

2. Prompt 2:

Direct Approach: Discontinuation of a Service

Context: You are the operations manager of a software company. Due to new regulatory constraints and company restructuring, one of the services provided to clients will no longer be available. You need to inform your clients about this decision.

Prompt: Write an email to your clients, directly stating the discontinuation of the service. Mention the reasons for this decision, the timeline for the service's cessation, and alternative solutions or recommendations you can offer. Convey your regrets about the inconvenience this might cause and your company's commitment to providing other high-quality services.

Your writing will be graded according to the following criteria:

Content	Tone and Professionalism	Clarity	Organization
20 points	10 points	10 points	10 points
Total:			

